

MAJOR PENTATONIC SCALE

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #117

The Major Pentatonic Scale is one of the important melodic sounds in human history. We find examples of the Pentatonic Scale in most cultures across the world, extending back for millennia. In short, you'll be a better global citizen if you know your Pentatonic Scales!

There are many types of pentatonic scales (literally a five-note scale), but the one we are looking at here is the Major Pentatonic. There is only one Major Pentatonic, and this is it.

#1 - C Major Pentatonic Scale



The "recipe" for a Pentatonic Scale, relative to the Major Scale, is
1 - 2 - 3 - 5 - 6 - 8

The Pentatonic Scale is less like a scale, in my mind, and more like a Melodic Shape. It's a "melody waiting to happen." It is difficult to play two or three notes from this collection of notes without sounding like you are playing a coherent melody. This is its strength.

#2 - Short pattern with the C Major Pentatonic Scale



#3 - Longer pattern with the C Major Pentatonic Scale

